

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET C — NCERT EXEMPLAR, IN-TEXT SOURCES & TRICKY QUESTIONS****CHAPTER 01: UNDERSTANDING SOCIAL SCIENCE**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-C-01

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET C - NCERT Exemplar & Tricky Questions):

1. The question paper comprises **25 NCERT Exemplar & Critical Application Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Tests **in-text source boxes, fine glossary definitions, historical source extracts, and tricky boundary cases**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

 **NCERT IN-TEXT & EXEMPLAR TIER:** Questions in this set explore subtle details, specialized definitions, and non-intuitive concepts drawn directly from official NCERT text margins, source boxes, and glossary entries.

Q.1 Which of the following documents is classified strictly as an 'epigraphic' source rather than a literary manuscript?

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|--|--|
| (A) The Besnagar pillar inscription of Heliodorus carved on a sandstone column | (B) A palm-leaf copy of Kalidasa's *Meghaduta* transcribed in the 17th century |
| (C) A printed paper edition of Kautilya's *Arthashastra* | (D) A handwritten diary maintained by a modern school teacher |

Q.2 What is the primary scientific reason why Radiocarbon dating (^{14}C) cannot be used to determine the age of geological dinosaur fossils from 65 million years ago?

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|---|--|
| (A) The half-life of ^{14}C is only $\sim 5,730$ years, meaning all measurable radioactive ^{14}C decays completely after roughly 50,000–60,000 years | (B) Dinosaur bones never contained any carbon atoms during their biological lifetime |
| (C) Dinosaur fossils are too heavy to fit into mass spectrometry radiation machines | (D) Carbon-14 was invented only during the Bronze Age by humans |

Q.3 In historical source analysis, an autobiography written by a political leader 40 years after holding office is classified as:

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|---|---|
| (A) A primary source, but one that must be critically cross-examined for selective memory, hindsight bias, and self-justification | (B) A completely flawless, 100% mathematically objective primary source |
| (C) A secondary source written by an unrelated outside observer | (D) A completely useless fictional mythology that must be discarded |

Q.4 The archaeological method of determining the relative chronological sequence of artifacts based on the depth of the earth's sedimentary soil layers is called:

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|---|----------------------------------|
| (A) Stratigraphy (Law of Superposition) | (B) Dendrochronology |
| (C) Thermoluminescence | (D) Carbon-14 radiometric dating |

Q.5 What dating technique calculates the absolute age of wooden timbers found in ancient architectural ruins by counting annual growth tree rings?

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|----------------------|------------------|
| (A) Dendrochronology | (B) Epigraphy |
| (C) Numismatics | (D) Palaeography |

Q.6 Why does a modern social scientist distinguish carefully between 'normative statements' and 'positive statements' in public policy?

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|--|---|
| (A) Positive statements describe objective facts of 'what is'; normative statements express value judgements of 'what ought to be' | (B) Positive statements are always happy; normative statements are always sad |
| (C) Positive statements apply only to mathematics; normative statements apply only to music | (D) There is no distinction; all statements in social science are purely mathematical equations |

Q.7 Which sub-discipline of history specializes in deciphering ancient scripts, analyzing letterforms, and dating ancient handwriting styles across centuries?

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|------------------|-----------------|
| (A) Palaeography | (B) Numismatics |
| (C) Cartography | (D) Demography |

Q.8 A researcher discovers that regions with higher ice-cream sales also report higher drowning accidents. What logical fallacy occurs if the researcher claims eating ice-cream causes drowning?

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|--|---|
| (A) Spurious correlation (confounding variable): both are caused by a third underlying factor—hot summer weather | (B) The Law of Diminishing Marginal Utility |
| (C) The Law of Superposition | (D) An unavoidable biological medical truth |

Q.9 What is an 'anachronism' in historical writing or cinema?

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|---|--|
| (A) Placing an object, custom, idea, or event in a historical time period where it could not possibly have existed (e.g., a wristwatch in an ancient Mauryan royal court) | (B) Writing a book in two languages simultaneously |
| (C) Excavating ancient coins from beneath river sand | (D) Carving an inscription on a granite stone pillar |

Q.10 How does the archaeological technique of 'flotation' recover microscopic plant remains from ancient settlement hearths?

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|--|---|
| (A) Excavated soil is agitated in water; dense mineral particles sink, while lightweight carbonized seeds and phytoliths float to the surface for microscopic botanical analysis | (B) Soil is dissolved in boiling industrial acid until only stone remains |
| (C) Archaeologists use remote satellites to take thermal x-rays of seeds | (D) Soil is baked in ovens until it turns into glass pottery |

Q.11 Why do historians refer to the period before the invention of written scripts as 'Prehistory', the period with undeciphered scripts as 'Protohistory', and the period with deciphered texts as 'History'?

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|---|---|
| (A) The classification is based strictly on the nature and decipherability of written textual records left by the human society | (B) Prehistory occurred in outer space, while History occurred on Earth |
| (C) The division is based on the color of clothing worn by ancient kings | (D) Protohistory is a fictional mythology that never existed |

Q.12 What is 'triangulation' in social science research methodology?

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|---|---|
| (A) Using multiple independent data sources, methods, or theoretical perspectives to cross-verify and validate a research finding | (B) Measuring triangular land boundaries using brass compasses only |
| (C) Restricting all research to exactly three historical individuals | (D) Drawing geometric triangles across a geographical map of Asia |

Q.13 Which discipline studies the linguistic evolution, structural relationships, and historical divergence of ancient and modern languages?

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|--|-------------------|
| (A) Historical Linguistics (Philology) | (B) Epigraphy |
| (C) Numismatics | (D) Geomorphology |

Q.14 Why is an 'ethnography' considered a distinctive qualitative research method in cultural anthropology?

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|---|--|
| (A) The researcher immerses themselves directly in the daily life of a community over an extended period (participant observation) to record cultural practices from an insider perspective | (B) The researcher distributes a multiple-choice computer test to 10,000 citizens online |
| (C) The researcher reads only government tax gazettes without meeting people | (D) The researcher measures human brain size using measuring tape |

Q.15 What is the primary difference between a 'gazetteer' and an ordinary travelogue in historical documentation?

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| (A) A gazetteer is an official, systematic geographical, administrative, and statistical compendium published by a government; a travelogue is a personal, subjective travel narrative | (B) A gazetteer contains only fictional poetry, while a travelogue contains legal statutes |
| (C) A travelogue is always carved into stone cliffs | (D) There is no difference; both are names for modern printed magazines |

Q.16 What is 'sample bias' in sociological survey research?

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|--|---|
| (A) A systematic flaw where the group surveyed is not statistically representative of the broader population, producing skewed and invalid conclusions | (B) A situation where everyone in a nation gives the exact same opinion |
| (C) A printing defect on paper survey forms | (D) A survey that asks questions only about food and cooking |

Q.17 How does 'paleo-climatology' assist historians in understanding the sudden collapse or migration of ancient agrarian civilisations?

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|--|--|
| (A) It reconstructs past weather, droughts, and rainfall shifts using lake sediment cores, tree rings, and cave stalagmites, correlating climate shocks with historical crises | (B) It claims that weather never changes across thousands of years |
| (C) It replaces all archaeological excavations with modern weather forecasting | (D) It proves that ancient societies did not rely on agriculture |

Q.18 What is the methodological meaning of the term 'subaltern' in modern historiography?

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|---|---|
| (A) Populations and social classes (peasants, Dalits, women, tribal groups, manual laborers) that are socially, politically, and geographically outside the hegemonic power structure | (B) A high-ranking military officer in a colonial naval fleet |
| (C) A royal prince who is third in line to an ancient throne | (D) A precious gemstone imported from ancient Egypt |

Q.19 Why must a social scientist distinguish between 'primary data' and 'secondary data' in statistical research?

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|---|---|
| (A) Primary data is collected first-hand by the researcher directly for the specific research question; secondary data is pre-existing data gathered by others (like government census tables) | (B) Primary data is always numerical; secondary data is always written in Latin |
| (C) Secondary data is illegal to use in scientific research | (D) Primary data is collected by children; secondary data is collected by adults |
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Q.20 What is the 'confirmation bias' trap that historians and researchers must consciously guard against?

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|---|---|
| (A) The human tendency to search for, favor, and remember information that confirms pre-existing beliefs while ignoring or dismissing contradictory evidence | (B) The legal requirement to confirm research findings with the local police |
| (C) A computer virus that deletes historical text files | (D) A celebration held when an archaeological site is discovered |
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Q.21 What is 'numismatic hoard analysis' and what can the condition of hoarded coins tell an economic historian?

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|--|---|
| (A) The debasement of coin alloy (replacing silver with copper) indicates fiscal crises, while clipped edges and buried emergency hoards indicate political instability and warfare | (B) The weight of coins indicates the physical height of the reigning king |
| (C) All buried coins were lost accidentally by careless children | (D) Coins with animal figures were used exclusively to buy zoo animals |
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Q.22 Why is 'oral testimony' considered vulnerable to distortion if not recorded promptly after a historical event?

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|--|---|
| (A) Human memory is reconstructive and can be reshaped over time by subsequent discussions, trauma, media exposure, and community consensus | (B) Human voices lose their acoustic pitch after ten years |
| (C) Old people are legally prohibited from speaking about the past | (D) Oral stories are forgotten completely within 24 hours |
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Q.23 What is 'spatial autocorrelation' in quantitative human geography (Tobler's First Law of Geography)?

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|---|---|
| (A) 'Everything is related to everything else, but near things are more related than distant things' | (B) All human beings in a city walk in identical straight lines |
| (C) A car moves faster on curved roads than on straight highways | (D) There is zero mathematical relationship between geographical locations |
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Q.24 In scientific philosophy, what does 'falsifiability' (proposed by Karl Popper) mean for a social scientific theory?

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| (A) A theory must be formulated in a way that empirical observation or evidence could potentially contradict and disprove it | (B) The theory must be proven false before it can be published in a journal |
| (C) The researcher must tell deliberate lies during interviews | (D) The theory must be approved by a political party |
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Q.25 Why is a multidisciplinary research ethics board (Institutional Review Board - IRB) required before conducting human subject research?

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|--|---|
| (A) To evaluate research protocols, ensure minimal risk to participants, guarantee voluntary consent, and protect privacy and human dignity | (B) To collect government taxes on academic books |
| (C) To ensure that only wealthy students conduct research | (D) To prevent students from asking questions in libraries |
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CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET C)

01	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25	☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET C)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.1	(A)	Epigraphic sources are strictly contemporary texts incised or engraved on durable hard surfaces like stone pillars, rock faces, or copper plates.
Q.2	(A)	With a half-life of 5,730 years, ^{14}C activity diminishes beyond detection after ~10 half-lives (50–60 millennia); ancient fossils require Potassium-Argon or Uranium-Lead dating.
Q.3	(A)	While authored by a direct participant (primary), retrospective autobiographies written decades later are prone to memory distortion, post-facto rationalization, and egoistic bias.
Q.4	(A)	Stratigraphy relies on the Law of Superposition: in undisturbed geological and archaeological strata, deeper soil layers are older than upper layers.
Q.5	(A)	Dendrochronology (tree-ring dating) matches sequences of annual tree growth rings in ancient timbers with master regional climatic tree-ring chronologies.
Q.6	(A)	Positive economics/sociology deals with testable empirical reality (e.g., inflation rate is 6%); normative analysis deals with ethical goals (e.g., inflation ought to be lower).
Q.7	(A)	Palaeography is the historical study of ancient and medieval handwriting styles, alphabet evolutions, and the decipherment of historical scripts.
Q.8	(A)	Spurious correlation occurs when two unrelated variables appear linked because both covary with an unobserved confounding variable (summer heat encourages both ice-cream and swimming).
Q.9	(A)	An anachronism is a chronological inconsistency that projects modern technology, concepts, or terms backward into historical eras where they did not exist.
Q.10	(A)	Flotation separates charred botanical seeds and grains (paleoethnobotany) by buoyancy in water tanks, revealing ancient crop choices and dietary patterns.
Q.11	(A)	Prehistory has zero written records (stone age); Protohistory has scripts we cannot yet read or external contemporary texts (Harappan civilization); History has decipherable written records.
Q.12	(A)	Methodological triangulation combines distinct data streams (e.g., surveys, archival texts, ethnographic interviews) to cross-check validity and eliminate research bias.
Q.13	(A)	Historical linguistics traces phonetic shifts, cognate words, and genealogical family trees (such as Proto-Indo-European) to chart human migrations.
Q.14	(A)	Ethnographic fieldwork requires immersive participant observation, building trust and documenting lived cultural meanings from the perspective of community members.
Q.15	(A)	Imperial gazetteers (e.g., Hunter's *Imperial Gazetteer of India*) were comprehensive administrative compendia of district geography, revenues, castes, and topography.
Q.16	(A)	Sampling bias occurs when sample selection favors specific groups (e.g., conducting an online survey in an area where 70% of poor citizens lack internet access).
Q.17	(A)	Paleoclimate proxies (oxygen isotope ratios in speleothems, pollen profiles) reveal severe megadroughts that triggered societal collapses (e.g., the 4.2 ka BP aridification event).
Q.18	(A)	Pioneered by Antonio Gramsci and developed by Ranajit Guha, Subaltern Studies focuses on marginalized voices subordinated by colonial, elite, or bourgeois hegemony.
Q.19	(A)	Primary data is generated *de novo* by the investigator via field experiments or surveys; secondary data re-analyzes published archives, censuses, or institutional datasets.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.20	(A)	Confirmation bias leads scholars to selectively cherry-pick sources that validate their favorite hypotheses while ignoring counter-evidence in archives.
Q.21	(A)	Numismatic debasement reflects state bankruptcy or inflation, while buried coin hoards correlate with military invasions where owners concealed wealth and never returned.
Q.22	(A)	Cognitive psychology shows memory is not a passive recording; it undergoes ongoing social reconstruction and post-event information contamination over decades.
Q.23	(A)	Waldo Tobler formulated this foundational axiom: geographic proximity creates clustering in socio-economic attributes, disease rates, and environmental variables.
Q.24	(A)	Popper argued that genuine scientific claims must make testable predictions capable of empirical refutation (falsification), distinguishing science from dogma.
Q.25	(A)	IRBs review research proposals to uphold the Belmont Report principles: respect for persons (autonomy), beneficence (do no harm), and distributive justice.